

The 3-Layer *Architecture*.

THE DESIGN PRINCIPLE FOR EVERYONE WHO BUILDS OUR CURRICULUM & MATERIALS

*We never split tracks by exam board. **One spine, two thinking tiers** stacked on top — the only layer where the boards truly diverge is the **exam adapter**, which swaps in at the very top.*

— LAYER 3 • EXAM ADAPTERS — fitted 1-2 years before the exam • swappable cartridges • the only layer where IGCSE & IB diverge —

ADAPTER A • SWAPPABLE

IGCSE Adapter

3 AOs (Knowledge 43 • Analysis 47 • Evaluation 10)
Paper 1/2 formats • no market-failure diagrams •
levels-of-response (d) questions

ADAPTER B • SWAPPABLE

IB Adapter

4 AOs • the command-term system • Paper 1 essays
(a)+(b)
Real-world examples (RWE) • data-response
technique

LAYER 2 • TIER 2 **Read the Map** *Judge • Evaluate • Connect*

Ages 13–15 (entry label: Pre-IB) — the
same topics, now carrying
definitions • diagrams • calculations •
evaluative writing

▲ Same topics — only the verbs get promoted ▲

LAYER 1 • TIER 1 **Draw the Map** *Play • Discover • Feel*

Ages 10–12 (entry label: Pre-IGCSE) — **games •**
simulations • stories:
concepts are discovered through experience before they
are defined

FOUNDATION • SPINE

One Conceptual Spine

18 lessons (3 modules × 6) • anchored subtopic-by-subtopic to Cambridge
IGCSE 0455 (2027–29) + IB DP Economics Guide (2022)
The two boards share ~80% of their conceptual DNA — **update here once**
and it flows to both tiers automatically

ENTRY POINT A

Ages 10–12 — enter at **Tier 1**,
advance to Tier 2 over time



ENTRY POINT B

Ages 13–15 (**IB-bound**) — enter **directly at Tier 2**.
Tier 1 is not a prerequisite.

BEFORE YOU BUILD — THE FIVE QUESTIONS

Q1 Where does it anchor on the spine?

Assign M#L# and check both syllabus references (Course Map v3
audit sheets)

Q2 Tier 1: can it be discovered through play?

Game before definition — the concept must emerge from the play
itself

Q3 Tier 2: what exactly did you promote?

Not a new topic — the same experience, now carrying definition →
diagram → evaluation

Q4 Is it board-specific content?

Then flag it △/HL and send it to the adapter layer — never into a
tier's core

Q5 When the world changes, what do you edit?

One place — the spine. Cases, news and games hang off it and flow
to both tiers

DO / DON'T

DO Run the same topic through both tiers with different **verbs** — Tier
1 feels it, Tier 2 judges it.

DO Keep exam technique in the Exam-skill column only — that
column is the seed of the adapter layer.

DON'T Duplicate the curriculum per board — 80% double work, and
one copy always goes stale.

DON'T Force a board choice at entry — a tier only asks "which
thinking stage are you at now?"

DON'T Teach XED • deflation (IGCSE) • fixed rates (IGCSE) • the
comparative-advantage model (SL) as core — they sit outside the
current syllabuses. Keep the △ flags.

"One spine. Two tiers. Swappable adapters."